

CARDBOARD CLOCK: ₹368



The most expensive part of this build is the movement, which can be purchased online. It is worth it to pay more for a better movement, but you can open up cheap clocks on sale to make a custom build as well.

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MATERIALS NEEDED

- 1x Quartz Clock Movement - ₹300
- Cardboard - Free
- 1x A4 Transparency - ₹10
- 1x Craft Crepe Paper (23 x 10 in) - ₹18
- 1x AA battery - ₹40

This one is pretty simple, and the end of it, you have a custom clock, that can be kept on a desk or hung on a wall. We created a Star Wars clock, but you can find other ways to creatively use the second, minute and hour hands, the clock face, and the casing. Send in images of your custom clocks to editor@digit.in, and we are giving out a free surprise gift to the best one.



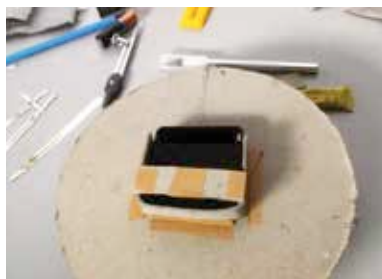
STEP 01 We got a Japanese quartz movement that was made in China. Quartz based movements are available online, and are shipped along with the hands. If you like the hands, you can opt to designing just the face, and forget tweaking the hands. However, we wanted custom hands as well.



STEP 02 We went for a circular clock, and designed a rather abstract face without the numbers, that we printed out on card paper. We went for a 70 gsm paper, using anything too thick would interfere with the mechanism. It is best to mark the center of the face while designing itself, using the graphics software of your choice.



STEP 03 We used a pen knife to cut the details into the hands. We used the lightsabers of Obi-Wan Kenobi, Anakin Skywalker and Kylo Ren. The movement has rings, like the layers of the onion. There are holes within the hands to accommodate the hand on top. The hour hand is in the outermost ring, with the largest hole, the minute hand sits on top of the hour hand and has a smaller hole. The second hand does not have a hole, and sits in the tiniest hole. The approach we found that works best is to use adhesive glue to attach the cutouts to the hands and then cut out the holes using any small, pointy object. Make sure the clock is working at this stage, as we found we had to bend the lightsabers a bit, as Obi-Wan's lightsaber was obstructing Skywalker's once every minute.



STEP 04 At the back of the clock, although it was not necessary, we fashioned a small case out of cardboard to secure the movement. This is just so that the movement does not fall off when the clock is held horizontally, while moving it.



STEP 05 Then we made a ring casing for the clock. The cardboard was covered with the space age looking silvery-grey crepe paper. The clock face was placed in the middle of the ring. We used the circular cutter to cut the transparency, and attached it to the inside of the ring with cello tape. It is best to use cello tape at only one point, let the transparency sheet swing out for access to the interiors. This can be replaced with glass if making a square clock, or skipped altogether. The idea is to provide some protection from the elements (pollution and dust) to the face and the hands.



STEP 06 Finally, for the back we cut out another circular cardboard portion, pasted crepe paper on top, and fashioned a basic stand by attaching a strip of cardboard, also with crepe paper pasted on top. That is it, our custom Star Wars clock was ready.